

400 Fundamental Desktop Publishing

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will apply foundational desktop publishing skills to produce creative marketing materials. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this application event. Contestants may not enter Fundamental Desktop Publishing and Advanced Desktop Publishing in the same year. This event may *not* be repeated.

Contestant Must Supply

- Published and/or unpublished non-electronic written reference materials
- Optional - Mac computer. Contestant must also bring software and extension cords. Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the contestant within the time allotted. Business Professionals of America assumes no responsibility for hardware/software provided by the contestant.

Equipment/Supplies Provided

- Computer and software
- Graphic files

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: application
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- All contestant-produced jobs completed on-site are uploaded electronically and are not printed at the national level
- No equipment, supplies or materials other than those specified for an event are allowed in the testing area
- Previous Business Professionals of America tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied or keyed) may not be taken into the testing area. Violation of this rule will result in disqualification
- Contestants can use software templates, but creativity points may be reduced
- Length of event: no more than ten (10) minutes orientation, no more than ninety (90) minutes testing time, and no more than ten (10) minutes wrap-up
- At NLC, contestants will take the Desktop Publishing I (YouScience) certification with their contest. Reference materials are not allowed for certification testing.
- Entries may vary by state

Contest Competencies

1. Apply skills in design, edit, and produce diverse business assets, including publications, logos, marketing materials, social media graphics, and website assets—for web, print, and mobile platforms
2. Integrate modern design principles & elements, responsive layout techniques, and foundational-level typography to create visually effective and brand-consistent publications across digital and print environments
3. Apply color theory, digital color management, and advanced graphic integration (vector illustrations, shapes, layered elements) to ensure visual consistency, brand alignment, and engagement across all publication formats
4. Design and produce multipage, multicolumn documents using master pages, styles, and templates for consistency and efficiency

This event is
endorsed by

